



Prying eyes: Centre Court's security team ensures Wimbledon's celebrated etiquette is upheld, from the stands to the press box. AFP

The crossover chronicles

From Centre Court to the FIFA World Cup, from Wimbledon's dog policy to visa woes, our correspondent's summer travels uncover the curious moments that often lie beyond the day's main story.

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The Diary is a crossover artist. In 2025, it covered the first two Test matches of the India-England series before shifting to Wimbledon. In 2026, it reported on Wimbledon before moving to India's three-match ODI series against England. But the Diary has also nurtured an enduring love for football since childhood, and because summer is when the sport's continental and global showpieces are mostly held, it had always hoped the 'Beautiful Game' would also

become part of its crossover story. That finally happened in 2026.

While covering tennis or cricket, the Diary has often returned home to a football match. And with the time-zone difference being less brutal than in India, it has enjoyed watching the game. However, the Diary took its crossover tale a bit too far. The Wimbledon men's singles quarterfinal between Novak Djokovic and Felix Auger-Aliassime was in the first-set tiebreak when Lionel Messi's Argentina was staging a miraculous comeback against Egypt in the World

Cup round of 16. Journalists seated on Centre Court started streaming the match one by one, and the Diary caught the action by stealth, peeping at the screen of the man seated in front. When Enzo Fernandez scored the injury-time winner, the enthusiastic Diary let out a mild scream. Djokovic and Auger-Aliassime were far too distant to be perturbed, but the security officer patrolling nearby gave the Diary a hard stare.

"You have broken the great Wimbledon etiquette of not cheering